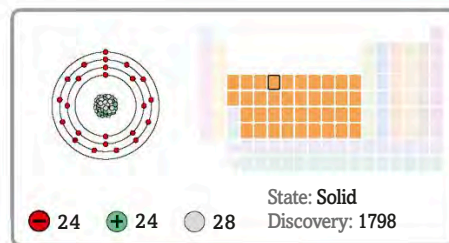


24
Cr

Chromium



Forms

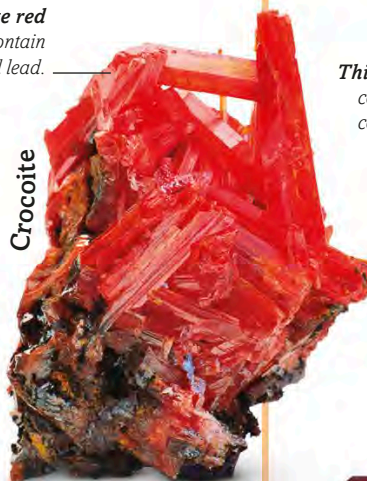


Chromite

Chromite is dark grey to brown in colour.

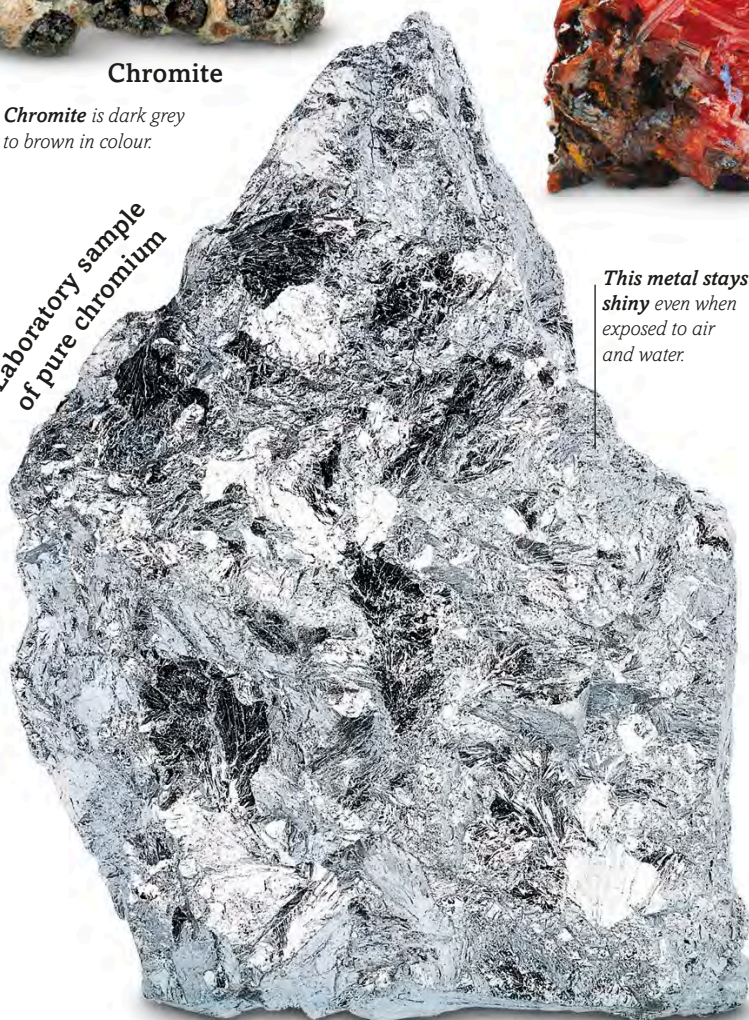
These large red crystals contain chromium and lead.

Crocoite



This metal stays shiny even when exposed to air and water.

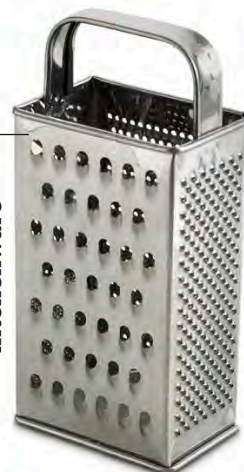
Laboratory sample of pure chromium



Uses

This grater can resist corrosion because it contains chromium.

Stainless steel kitchenware



Ruby



This red colour is due to the presence of tiny amounts of chromium oxide in the crystal.

The chromium plating protects this motorbike from rusting.

Motorcycle



Chromium is named after *chroma*, the Greek word for “colour”. Many minerals of chromium, including **chromite** and **crocoite**, are brightly coloured. An artificial form of crocoite, known as “chrome yellow”, was once used in paints, but it was banned when scientists discovered it to be

poisonous. **Pure chromium** doesn’t corrode easily, so it is combined with iron and carbon to produce **stainless steel**. Chromium also gives gemstones, such as **rubies**, their deep-red colour. Some **motorcycles** have chromium-plated bodywork, giving them a shiny finish.